

**ENCLOSURE TO**  
**FLEET MONTHLY**  
**ROR – OCT 2018**

**FLEET RULE OF THE ROAD TEST FOR OCT 2018**

This test is based on: The International Regulations for Preventing Collisions at Sea (1972) with amendments in force up to December 2009 as detailed in "A Seaman's Guide Pocket Book of The International Regulations for Preventing Collisions at Sea" (BR 453 Supp), ATP1(G) Vol II, NP735 and the Mariners Handbook (NP100).

The test is designed to be given to any Warfare Officer, Deck officer, Officer undertaking bridge watch-keeping duties or Young Officer/Cadet. The test should be administered under written exam conditions, the results should be recorded in the OOW training records for inspection by FOST navigation staff. The exam should take no longer than 1.5 hrs.

In this test, any change in the status of the ship or of the environment will be indicated in the script. Rules 1 to 19, 34, 35 and Annex IV must be known instinctively for instant application. A thorough knowledge of the other rules is required. The pass mark is 90%.

**PART 1**

1. **Describe a southerly cardinal buoy including light characteristics and the recommended navigable side. (NP735)(2.5)**
  
  
  
  
  
  
  
  
  
  
2. **Other than the special rules applicable to Allied naval ships, IRPCS is to be observed by ships in formation. True or False?(ATP 1G Vol II Art 141)(0.5)**
  
  
  
  
  
  
  
  
  
  
3. **Ships joining, leaving, approaching or passing through a formation must not hamper which units? (ATP 1G Vol II Art 141)(1)**
  
  
  
  
  
  
  
  
  
  
4. **What shape(s) and lights should towing vessels display (assuming length of tow over 200m)? (R24a)(3)**

1. Define the term vessel “restricted in her ability to manoeuvre”. Give 6 examples of such work?(**R3g**)(4)

5. How should a vessel maintain a proper look-out?(**R5**)(1)

6. If radar is fitted and operational, how should it be used?(**R7b**)(1)

7. Nothing in these Rules shall exonerate any vessel or the owner, master or crew from what?(**R2a**)(1)

8. What does the term vessel not under command mean?(**R3f**)(1)

9. Describe the sound signals made by a vessel engaged in fishing at anchor in restricted visibility (**R35 c&d**)(1)

10. Indicate 6 methods of how a ship can indicate she is in distress.(**Annex IV**)(3)

11. Describe the lights displayed by a vessel engaged in fishing, other than trawling when making way through the water **(R26c(i)(iii))(3)**

12. What is the minimum range a vessel is authorised to close a vessel engaged in mine clearance operations? **(R27f)(1)**

13. When is a vessel deemed to be overtaking another? **(R13b)(1)**

14. When is a vessel deemed to be in sight of one another? **(R3k)(1)**

## Part 2

You are the Navigating Officer of HMS DEFENDER (length 152.4m) departing PORTSMOUTH Monday afternoon for a Capability Demonstration in London (West India Quay). The pilot is embarked, 2 tugs are in attendance and SSD is closed up. Fog is expected in the North Sea later on in the day. You have been given clearance by QHM to sail.

14. Shortly after sailing, over VHF Channel 12 you hear Southampton VTS talking to the captain of a dredger working just south of Outer Spit Buoy.

a. How would the dredger indicate her special condition and which side is obscured/free to pass? **(R27bii & di/ii)(3)**

b. What lights would this vessel display if under way and making way at night, length 125 metres and obstructions caused by her dredging equipment on her port side? **(R27bii & di/ii)(2)**

15.

16. You notice a sailing vessel at Green 15 range 5c on steady bearing and does not appear to be taking any action. What could you do to indicate your concern? **(R34d)(1)**

17. In accordance with the Rules, what should the sailing vessel avoid doing? **(R9b)(1)**

18. What is your obligation should risk of collision exist? **(8f(iii), 18a)(1)**

19. As you go through the Round Tower gap, you notice a Container vessel at Green 45 range 4nm coming from Southampton. You anticipate there is possibility of close quarters around OSB and inform the pilot you intend to reduce speed as it is a crossing situation and you are the give way vessel. The pilot tells you that in order not to delay the next move, he will direct the vessel to wait for you to exit the narrow channel. Is this seamanlike and why?**(R1b)(2)**

20. You eventually pass Nab tower and SSD falls out. Your Navtrack takes you directly to the TSS. How are you meant to join a TSS?(**R10b(iii)**)(2)

21. As your track crossed the SW traffic flow, what advise will you give the OOW before you depart the bridge?(**R10f**)(1)

22. You spot a vessel engaged in fishing in the Traffic Separation Zone. Is she allowed in the zone? On what occasions are you permitted in the separation zone? (**R10e**)(3)

23. You detect one of the cross channel ferries at Red 30 at 5nm crossing the TSS with a CPA of 3c ahead. How is she meant to cross a TSS?(**R10c**)(1)

24. You deem risk of collision to exist. Who is the give way vessel?(**R15**)(1)

25. The situation continuous to build with no change in CPA, what initial action is required of your ship?(**R17a(i)**)(1)

26. As neither ship has taken action to avoid collision, when and how **may** the stand-on vessel take action?(**R17a(ii)**)(1)

27. Just when the ferry passed at 5c astern, you notice another ferry at Green 50 at 2nm. The CO who came on the bridge for the previous incident asks if risk of collision exist with this ferry. How can this be determined noting her proximity and high speed?(**R7d**)(2)

28. On taking the second bearing, you notice the bearing is drawing slowly left but still not sure if risk of collision exist. What action does the Rule recommend if you need more time to make an assessment?(**R8e**)(1)

29. The ferry passes ahead at 5c and your next consideration is a MV proceeding at 8kts which you intend to overtake on the port side. What sound signals will you use and what response do you expect from her if she is in agreement?(**R34c**)(2)

30. You safely overtake the MV and safely cross the TSS to your holding box overnight. As you patrol your box, you notice visibility is reducing. When do the rules for restricted visibility apply?(**R19a**)(1)

31. What sound signals would you need to be making whilst patrolling your box?(**R35a**)(1)

32. You hear apparently forward of your beam 1 prolonged followed by 2 short blasts. You cannot determine if risk of collision exists. What should be your immediate action?(**R19e**)(2)

33. Your 200W reports a radar contact ahead at 3nm and you assess the contact ties in with the sound signal. What actions are you required to take and what must be avoided?(**R19d**)(2)

34. What type of contact could this be?(**R35c&d**)(3)

35. You suspect the contact is a sailing vessel underway (greater than 20m). What lights will you brief your fog lookout to look out for?(**R25a**)(1)

36. What additional lights may the sailing vessel display?(**R25c**)(1)

37. You brief the team to be on the lookout for the pilot vessel. What lights will they be looking out for if she is underway?(**R29a(i)(ii)**)(2)

38. You notice an outbound Bulk carrier ahead of the ship with a CPA of 1c to starboard. You report it is a head on situation. How is this defined?(**R14b**)(1)

39. What action is required from both units?(**R14a**)(1)

40. The pilot informs you that a vessel constrained by her draught is heading outbound. What must you avoid doing?(**R18d**)(1)

41. You notice a small ferry at Green 45 lining up to cross to the other side. What does the Rule say about her actions; you can safely navigate only within the channel?(**R9d**)(1)

42. She starts to cross and CPA is steady and does not appear to be taking action so you sound 5 short blasts. In what manner did you expect her to act as required by the circumstances of the case?(**R8f(i)**)(1)

43. The XO asks the YO to define a short blast. What answer will you expect if he was correct?(**R32b**)(1)

You eventually get alongside port side for a stand-easy followed by preparation for the Capability Demonstration.

**Part 2**            \_\_\_\_\_ /44

**TOTAL**            \_\_\_\_\_ /69